Constitution[43] was all the more deficient for incorporating 'absolutely nothing' from the *Manusmriti*). Upadhyaya thus felt the need for a Hindu political philosophy befitting an ancient nation like Bharat. This would have to be based on a positive concept of patriotism and a comprehensive vision of the nation as a complete entity—its security, its unity, its growth and development, the welfare of its entire populace and the full development of every individual—based on its inherent character, culture, spiritual underpinnings and permanent values that have, as he saw them, stood the test of time.

For Upadhyaya, India had a special personality distinct from that of other nations; it had an ethos of its own. Only a national philosophy that reflected this could be successful; only an authentic Indian approach would ensure happiness for Indians. Upadhyaya was convinced that independent India could not rely upon Western concepts like individualism, democracy, socialism, communism or capitalism; it had to reject these formulae and find its own approach. Unfortunately, in his view, India's polity after Independence had been built upon these superficial and feeble Western foundations rather than authentic Hindu ones.

To Upadhyaya, Western thought was predicated on ideas of conflict: it presumed a conflict between individual and society, between ruler and ruled, between the power of clergy and temporal power, between haves and have-nots. Indian thinking, on the other hand, laid emphasis on cooperation and synthesis, not conflict. But Upadhyaya went further in his exegesis. To the Western mind, he argued, the main theme of this conflict was over rights: rights of the individual and the groups he represented. This was where Hinduism was different. To Upadhyaya, the Bharatiya ethos emphasised duties, not rights; it required coordination and understanding, not conflict and hatred. All India needed to do, Upadhyaya averred, was to 'turn the searchlight inwards' and base its thinking on 'self-revelation', just as the Hindu seeker looked within himself for self-realisation. India's polity had to be anchored in the traditions and ethos of India's own ancient Hindu culture.

As we have seen, Upadhyaya was clear that reducing the Indian national idea to a territory and the people on it was fallacious. It was this